

Robert Charles Goodwin

Red Bluff, 4 January 1925 · San Mateo County, 13 March 2014 · Skylawn Memorial Park, veterans' section. A Sacramento Valley boy raised in Eureka, San Francisco and Burlingame by his mother and the stepfather he called father; a nineteen-year-old pump station operator on the longest military pipeline of the Second World War, from Assam through Burma toward China; a brake man and mechanic on the Peninsula for the rest of his life; the father of Susan and Betty, and the grandfather whose first name Bobby carries.

Compiled 4 September 2026 for Robert Anthony Goodwin and Elizabeth Lenora Goodwin by Grace Marie Goodwin, from the census, the Army's records and the 775th's own morning reports, the county recorder, the city directories and the newspapers. A companion to the family page, Goodwin & Oviatt Lines.

89 years, 1925 to 2014	2 y 9 m in the Army, 1943 to 1946	721 days overseas	3 campaigns: India-Burma, Central Burma, China Defensive
14 morning-report entries in his name, 1943 to 1944	2 daughters, Susan and Betty		



Myitkyina, Burma, 10 August 1944. Men of Robert's company, the 775th Engineer Petroleum Distribution Company, unload pipe flown in from India from a C-47, a week after the town fell. U.S. Air Force photograph, National Archives.

TEN CHAPTERS

The life, in order

Everything below rests on a record named in the sources at the end; where the records fall silent, the text says so.

RED BLUFF, 4 JANUARY 1925

A Foley grandson in the Sacramento Valley

Robert Charles Goodwin was born on 4 January 1925 at Red Bluff, the county seat of Tehama County in California's upper Sacramento Valley, the second child and first son of Charles Herbert Goodwin and Lenora Augusta Foley. His father, born in a Kansas sod house in 1897 and raised in the logging country of Washington, had come to Red Bluff with his parents about 1917, gone to the Army in the World War, and married seventeen-year-old Nora Foley in the Catholic church there on 21 November 1921. His mother was the third of nine children of Pinkney Foley, a Kentucky-Missouri farmer's son who had come to Red Bluff in 1897, and Mary Clara DeRose, whose parents had come from the Portuguese islands of Pico and Madeira. Robert was named Robert for no one that the records show and Charles for his father; the name would pass to his grandson.

The only photograph of him as a child is the Foley family portrait taken about 1925 under a tree at Red Bluff. His father stands at the left holding his sister Dolores, who was born in August 1923; his mother stands at the right with the baby in her arms, beside her own mother, Mary DeRose Foley, and between them stand Nora's brothers Victor, Phillip, Joaquin and Angelo in overalls and her sisters Cecelia and Lucille. He was two years old when the family began to move for work: his brother Harold Philip was born at Cottage Grove in the Oregon timber country on 8 December 1926, and his sister Patricia Mae at Eureka, on the Humboldt coast, on 31 May 1928.



About 1925, Red Bluff: Charles Goodwin holding Dolores at left, Nora holding baby Robert at right beside her mother Mary DeRose Foley, and Nora's brothers and sisters between them.

EUREKA, 1930

J Street, and a household without a father

The 1930 census found the family at 539 J Street in Eureka, and it tells the story of the marriage in a single column. Nora, 25, is written down as head of the household; her husband is not in the house. With her are Dolores, 6, Robert, 5, Harold, 3, and Patricia, 1, and boarding with them are Charles's brother Albert Goodwin, 26, and Albert's small son Eugene. Charles was elsewhere, and the marriage

was over in all but name. A cousin's family tree places him at Summit City in Shasta County, the construction camp for Shasta Dam, by 1942; he married again, to Susie Marie Jones, and after her death in 1969 to Jane Beggs, and died at Martinez in 1985 at 88. He and Robert lived within an hour of each other for most of their adult lives; whether they saw each other the records do not say.

On 5 May 1933, at Gold Beach on the Oregon coast, Nora married Joseph Perry Rocha, a Humboldt County man of Azorean parents born at Arcata in 1904. Robert was eight. From then on Joseph Rocha was his father in every practical sense, and the two men kept faith with that for forty years: Robert's draft card in 1943 names 'Mr. Joseph P. Rocha (father)' as the person who would always know where he was; the 1950 census lists him in Joseph's house as a stepson; and when Joseph died in 1973 his obituary counted 'two sons, Robert and Harold Goodwin, both of San Mateo.'

SAN FRANCISCO, 1935 TO 1940

Shotwell Street

By 1935 the Rochas had moved to San Francisco, and on 1 April 1940 the census taker found them at 517 Shotwell Street in the Mission District: Lenora Rocha, 35, with Dolores, 16, Robert, 15, Harold, 13, and Patricia, 11. Robert was in the eighth grade at fifteen, a year or two behind, which fits a childhood spent moving between Red Bluff, Oregon, Eureka and the city. He would finish three years of high school, his Army papers say, and no more; the war came first.

Channing Road and the tire shop

The family settled on the Peninsula, at 14 Channing Road in Burlingame, a few blocks from the Southern Pacific station. Joseph Rocha was a partner in the Panko and Rocha Tire Company, with its shop at 247 California Drive, and Robert went to work for him there. The first time his name appears in a newspaper is as an usher: on Saturday, 6 June 1942, the afternoon the news from Midway was still coming in, his sister Dolores married John Matthew Farrell Jr. at St. Catherine's Church in Burlingame, in white satin with a cluster of gardenias, given away by Mr. Rocha, and the San Mateo Times reported that 'ushers were Robert Goodwin and Edward Reininger.' The bride, the paper noted, 'has one sister, Patricia, and two brothers, Robert and Harold,' and among the guests were Mrs. Mary Lorenzo of Arcata and Mrs. Evelyn Costa of Red Bluff, the Rocha and Foley connections come down for the day.

Seven months later, on 4 January 1943, Robert turned eighteen and registered for the draft the same day. The card survives, filled out in his own hand: Robert Charles Goodwin, 14 Channing Road, Burlingame, telephone Burlingame 3-2125, born Red Bluff, employed by Joseph P. Rocha at 247 California Drive. Local Board 104 in San Mateo called him up within three months.

REGISTRATION CARD (Men born on or after July 1, 1924, and on or before December 31, 1924.)
(Also for the registration of men as they reach the 18th anniversary of the date of their birth on or after January 1, 1943.)

SERIAL NUMBER	1. NAME (Print)	ORDER NUMBER
W. 88	Robert Charles Goodwin	13092
2. PLACE OF BIRTH (Print)	(The place of residence given on line 2 above will determine local board jurisdiction; line 3 of registration certificate will be identical)	
14 Channing Rd Burlingame Sm. Calif.		
3. MAILING ADDRESS	Same	
4. TELEPHONE	5. AGE IN YEARS	6. PLACE OF BIRTH
Blyme 3-2125	18	Red Bluff
7. NAME AND ADDRESS OF EMPLOYER WHO YOU ALWAYS KNOW YOUR ADDRESS		
Joseph P. Rocha (father) 14 Channing Rd Burlingame		
8. EMPLOYER'S NAME AND ADDRESS		
Joseph P. Rocha		
9. PLACE OF EMPLOYMENT OR BUSINESS		
247 California Dr Blyme Sm. Calif.		
I AFFIRM THAT I HAVE FURNISHED ABOVE ANSWERS AND THAT THEY ARE TRUE.		
DRAFT BOARD 1 (Rev. 11-29-42) 410-31020-4 (OVER) Robert Goodwin		

Robert's draft registration card, filled out on his eighteenth birthday, 4 January 1943, in his own hand: 14 Channing Road, Burlingame; employer Joseph P. Rocha, 247 California Drive; and 'Mr. Joseph P. Rocha (father)' as the man who would always know his address.

Private Goodwin, 39130554

He was inducted into the Army of the United States at San Francisco on 9 April 1943, a 'selectee, single, without dependents,' with three years of high school and, in the clerk's words, the civilian occupation of 'student, high school, academic.' The Army gave him serial number 39130554, carried him for a week in the inactive Enlisted Reserve Corps, and put him on active duty on 16 April. On 26 May 1943 he qualified as a marksman with the .30-caliber rifle. Where he did that, the discharge does not say, but the Army's morning reports and orders, which the National Archives has now digitized and made searchable by serial number, follow him from his first posting. He went to the Quartermaster Replacement Training Center at Fort Francis E. Warren, outside Cheyenne, Wyoming, and trained there in Company F of the 2d Quartermaster Training Regiment, where the Army carded him not as a student but as an automotive mechanic, specification serial number 014: the trade he had learned at his stepfather's tire shop. On 2 August 1943 Special Orders 214 of the training center sent him east with a draft of trained men to the Army Service Forces Unit Training Center at Camp Ellis, Illinois, on the prairie west of Peoria, where he was attached to the 618th Quartermaster Bakery Battalion and, on 12 August, assigned to Company B of the 619th, a battalion of Army bakers. Company B's morning report for 17 August 1943 carries his name and number, a private, with the code 521, 'basic,' beside it.

He was not to be a baker. That same month, as the decision to build a pipeline to China came out of the Quebec conference, the War Department constituted fifteen new Engineer Petroleum Distribution Companies, the 775th through the 789th, to assemble and train at Camp Claiborne, Louisiana, and they needed men. Paragraph 8 of Special Orders 152 from Camp Ellis, dated 2 September 1943, transferred Private Robert C. Goodwin and a company's worth of quartermaster trainees to the 775th Engineer Petroleum Distribution Company; the Camp Claiborne orders of 10 September list him among the men assigned, and the company's own roster of new arrivals has him under G. He was eighteen, a private, 'basic,' and about to be taught to run a pump.

Camp Claiborne, in the pine country south of Alexandria, Louisiana, was where the 775th became a company, under Captain Hugh C. Adams of the Corps of Engineers, who would command it through the whole war. The company's December 1943 payroll shows Private Goodwin drawing a private's pay with no allotments and \$6.40 a month deducted for a \$10,000 National Service Life Insurance

Par. 8 SO 152, Hq. ASFUTO, Camp Ellis, Illinois, dtd 2 Sept 1943

FROM 618th QM BATTALION (CONTINUED)		
Pvt Cohen, Leonard (MHI)	36860282	521
Pvt Cohen, Joe R.	37659350	521
Pvt Kerschmeyer, Maurice (MHI)	36462331	521
Pvt Laughlin, Lloyd A.	39131463	521
Pvt Ritzenthaler, Gilbert F.	36860176	521
Pvt Cohen, Sidney	38877215	521
Pvt Gouger, Rupert B.	36229653	521
Pvt Grande, Harold L.	36639859	521
Pvt Jackson, Robert L. Jr.	36269288	521
Pvt Kline, Carl	37473784	521
Pvt Castele, Anthony V.	35776041	521
Pvt Hagelmann, Glen C.	37322857	521
Pvt Klautz, Louis	36131673	521
Pvt Smith, Clifford L., Jr.	36134501	521
Pvt Dackowski, Salvatore	36134407	014
Pvt Leavitt, Ray S.	36134579	014
Pvt Clayton, Albert M.	36462237	014
Pvt Vanklin, Stanley H.	36639299	521
Pvt Arpisa, Paul	36462561	521
Pvt Bartolomucci, Antonio	36237007	521
Pvt C Stoness, Bernardino	36639236	521
Pvt Clark, John W.	14111840	521
Pvt Finley, James J.	36134593	521
Pvt Geligano, Anthony	37474751	521
Pvt Brynawn, John	36462888	521
Pvt Schumaker, Frank J.	36639423	521
FROM 618th QM BATTALION		
Pvt Terry, Earl A.	36239687	521
Pvt Sundquist, Loyd L.	37559184	521
Pvt Stauffer, Edward C.	37014884	521
Pvt Blago, Albert J.	37131553	521
Pvt Priokett, Melvin C.	37350507	014
Pvt Price, A. J.	36543057	521
Pvt Fomero, George W.	37659207	521
Pvt Locke, Vuklev C.	36460350	014
Pvt Kolbe, Walter F.	36619297	521
Pvt Chaney, John R., Jr.	37013213	521
Pvt Bridgett, Eugene E.	37813411	521
Pvt Rosel, Romley H.	36639747	014
Pvt Hall, Kenneth S.	36814107	014
Pvt Genselives, Albro (MHI)	37040103	014
Pvt Berger, Clarence J.	36817332	521
Pvt Weaver, Harry E.	36598147	014
Pvt Schmidt, Robert H.	37811487	014
Pvt Goodwin, Robert H.	39130554	521
Pvt Huppe, Jordan D.	36478955	521
Pvt O'Leary, Richard D.	37659450	521
Pvt Schuler, Paul H.	37351341	521
Pvt Riley, George (MHI)	36742225	521
Pvt Hargrove, Armando M.	36639215	521
Pvt Galy, Henry F.	36474243	521
S/S O'Grady, Augusta A.	14094328	521
Pvt Burgess, Paul C.	36239793	521
Pvt Keeling, James D.	37659797	521
Pvt Vesting, Arthur S.	11039654	521
Pvt Anderson, Joel S.	37189757	521
Pvt Vajda, Benjamin M.	6842156	521
Pvt Ward, John B.	36639170	521
Pvt Weinstein, Jack (MHI)	36894432	521
Pvt Tucker, James E.	6886	521
Pvt Sutton, Howard E.	34505322	521
Pvt Mandato, Joseph S.	11118030	014

RECEIVED

The orders that made him a pipeline man: an extract of Special Orders 152, Headquarters Army Service Forces Unit Training Center, Camp Ellis, Illinois, 2 September 1943, transferring privates of the 619th Quartermaster Bakery Battalion to the 775th Engineer Petroleum Distribution Company. 'Goodwin, Robert, 39130554, 521' is on the list. National Archives, Record Group 64, Morning Reports, September 1943, roll 164.

policy, the largest a soldier could buy. Before they left he got home once. The morning report of 14 November 1943 sends 'Goodwin, R C, Pvt' from duty to a twelve-day furlough, and the report of the 26th has him back, so he spent Thanksgiving 1943 at 14 Channing Road in Burlingame and did not see it again for more than two years.

CAMP PATRICK HENRY TO LEDO, JANUARY TO FEBRUARY 1944

Aboard the Empress of Scotland

On 9 January 1944 the 775th left Camp Patrick Henry, the staging camp of the Hampton Roads Port of Embarkation in Virginia, by train at noon, detrained at the pier at one o'clock, and walked aboard the Empress of Scotland, the former Canadian Pacific liner Empress of Japan, now a troopship, 'for unknown destination. Troops billeted. Morale fair.' The company was assigned mess detail for the whole voyage. They sailed on the 11th, the date on Robert's discharge, 221 enlisted men and their officers among the thousands aboard, and the destination revealed itself by the route: south through the Atlantic to Cape Town, where the ship lay a day or two and sailed again at half past three on the afternoon of 28 January, leaving behind, the clerk notes without comment, a lieutenant and a staff sergeant who had missed her and were handed to the naval attaché; then across the Indian Ocean to Bombay, reached on 8 February 1944, when the 'company commended on its performance of duty aboard ship. Morale excellent.'

Then India by rail. They debarked at half past eight on the morning of the 9th and boarded 'A' Special Train No. 251, Block C, Captain Adams appointed train commander, bound for Sirajganj Ghat on the Brahmaputra. The reports mark the stations of a journey across the whole width of the subcontinent: Manmad at midnight on the 10th, Goteagaon on the 11th, Madhopur on the 12th; on the 15th they reached Tistamukh at six in the morning, 'changed river steamers,' and made Dhubri by midnight; on the 16th the steamer was 'sailing north on the Brahma Pu-Tra River,' as the clerk spelled it, 'weather clear and cool, morale very good.' On 18 February 1944, at seven in the evening, the company detrained at Baragolai, the railhead beside Ledo in the far corner of Assam, and was billeted in the staging area, ten days out of Bombay and forty from Virginia. By the 22nd its station read 'Base Section 3, APO 689,' the Army post office for Ledo, the head of the road and of the pipeline into Burma.

CAMPY
MORNING REPORT

ENDING ZERO
 DATE

10-4
 YEAR

STATION APO #9094, o/o Postmaster, NY, NY
 ORGANIZATION 775th EFD Co

SERIAL NUMBER NAME GRADE CODE

18158753 Moreno Pfc
 Rd to gr of Pvt as of 1 Jan 44
 per par 1 Co o 21 dtd 1 Jan 44
 25218610 Cook Pfc
 32849146 Hamilton, L B Pvt
 32563583 Keys Pfc
 Aptd T/5 as of 1 Jan 44 per par
 2 Co o 21 dtd 1 Jan 44
 33741985 Cookrill T/4
 33005455 Zapp S/Set
 13120761 Gray S/Set
 Rd to gr of Pvt per par 1 Co o 22

RECORD OF EVENTS

Departed Up Patrick Henry Va 1200 hrs via train retained 1300 hrs and embarked on Empress of Scotland for unknown destination. Troops billeted. Morale fair.

OFFICER ELEMENTARY	F.O.D CAPT		IST LT		SD LT		W/O		PLT O	
	PRES	ASST	PRES	ASST	PRES	ASST	PRES	ASST	PRES	ASST
ASSIGNED			1	5						
ATTACHED UNASSIGNED ATTACHED IN OTHER ORDN										
TOTAL	1		1	5						

AVN CADET ENLISTED SERIAL NO	AVIATION CADETS		PRESENT		PREV PRESENT		ABSENT		PREVIOUSLY ON DUTY	
	PRES	ASST	PRES	ASST	PRES	ASST	PRES	ASST	PRES	ASST
ASSIGNED			221		1		222			
ATTACHED UNASSIGNED ATTACHED IN OTHER ORDN										
TOTAL			221		1		222			

DAY OF WEEK	ESTIMATED NUMBER OF RATIONS REQUIRED FOR DAY		DATE		TOTAL	AVERAGE
	MEAL ATTENDANCE FOR DAY OF THIS REPORT	WEED ATTENDANCE FOR DAY OF THIS REPORT	DATE	DATE		
A	227	227	681	1	227	
T						
O						
I						
E						
N						
S						

PAGE 1 OF 1 PAGES

(CHECK IF TRUE) MATCHES RECORDS ON HAND AND THAT RECORD FORMED IN THAT COUNTRY OR OUTPOST REPORT AS REQUESTED TO BE

REPORT MADE BY: HUGH C. ADAMS

CHIEF, REP. COE

REMARKS: H. C. ADAMS

The company's morning report for 9 January 1944: 'Departed Cp Patrick Henry Va 1200 hrs via train. Detrained 1300 hrs and embarked on Empress of Scotland for unknown destination. Troops billeted. Morale fair.' Signed by Captain Hugh C. Adams. National Archives, Record Group 64, Morning Reports, January 1944, roll 722.

ASSAM AND NORTH BURMA, 1944

The pump station operator on the Ledo Road

The petroleum distribution companies of the China-Burma-India theater built and ran the longest military pipeline of the war: four- and six-inch pipe laid beside the Ledo Road from the Assam oilfields at Digboi across the Patkai mountains and through the jungle of northern Burma, joined in 1945 to the old Burma Road and pushed on to Kunming in China. Pumping stations were spaced along its length to lift the aviation gasoline, motor fuel and diesel over the passes and keep it moving, and running one of those stations was Robert's job; the Army's manual describes the pump operator as the man who 'starts pumps and increases or decreases force of pumping as operating conditions warrant' and keeps the engines running. Fuel for Freedom, the Army's own account of the line written in 1945, records that the 699th, 706th and 775th 'arrived in Ledo and took over construction of the line' in February 1944, with none of their trucks, welders or heavy equipment yet in the theater, 'so the engineers were forced to borrow what they could from units working on the Ledo Road.' The road in those months was a one-way track over the Patkais into the Hukawng Valley; the first truck had been fueled from the pipeline at the 48-mile mark on 4 February, and Shingbwiyang, at mile 103, got its first aviation gasoline on 19 May.

The company's reports follow it down the road. On 4 April 1944 it 'completed movement to new campsite at 123 M.P.,' mile post 123 of the Ledo Road, twenty miles beyond Shingbwiyang in the Hukawng Valley of Burma, 'bivouac area flat and dry; weather sunny and warm; morale excellent,' and through the monsoon summer, while its station stayed Base Section 3, its men worked in detachments strung along the line: in the second week of August the reports count 116 of 186 men 'authorized to mess separately,' with parties at mile post 155 and at Warazup, mile 189, where the pipeline head then stood. Robert's name does not appear in those months, which in a morning report is good news: no sickness, no trouble, no transfer, a private at his pump. The exception is the photograph. When Myitkyina fell on 3 August 1944, 'within nine days the 775th EPD Company had been flown into the battered airstrip and had received 20 miles of pipe by air,' and the Air Force photographer who found them there on 10 August made the picture at the head of this page. Whether Robert was among the men flown in, the reports do not say; the company headquarters was still at Ledo.



Men of Robert's company, the 775th Engineer Petroleum Distribution Company, unloading pipe sections from a Douglas C-47 of a combat cargo squadron at Myitkyina, Burma, 10 August 1944, a week after the town fell. The pipe was flown in from India. U.S. Air Force photograph 123481AC, National Archives.

On 1 September 1944, at Ledo, the company order that made Herndon a staff sergeant and Hutchisson a sergeant made Private Goodwin a Technician Fifth Grade, a corporal's pay for a specialist's job, the rank he would hold to his discharge. Six days later the company's station changed. The report for 7 September 1944 is headed 'APO 218,' the Army post office at Myitkyina, and from then to the end of the year the 775th was a Myitkyina company, building the tank farm the Signal Corps photographers recorded: a 1,000-barrel tank, a 5,000-barrel tank, and six 10,000-barrel tanks on stone bases within reach of the airstrip, on ground from which the engineers first cleared forty-nine Japanese booby traps. The men who fell sick went to the 48th Evacuation Hospital at Myitkyina, and on 21 November 1944 Robert was one of them: 'Goodwin, Robert C, 39130554, Tec 5,' one of three men that day 'fr dy to sk 48th Evac Hosp APO 218, LD yes,' line of duty, which is the Army's way of saying an illness and not a wound. He was back on duty on the 25th, four days later.

MYITKYINA TO BHAMO, DECEMBER 1944

Twenty-four men to Bhamo

By December the line was moving again. The report of 20 December 1944 records that 'the 5th 10,000 bbl tank at tank farm completed and tested. Two line laid across Irrawaddy River. First 25 miles of line toward Bhamo completed. Operation turned over to 776 Engr PD Co.' Bhamo, the old river port on the Irrawaddy sixty miles south, had fallen to the Chinese 38th Division on 15 December after a month's siege. On the 21st the company sent an advance party ahead, 'twenty-four EM from duty to temporary duty at Bhamo, approximately 7 days,' under Staff Sergeant Robert Crume, who had already been twenty miles down the Bhamo road, and the list attached to the report names them, from Technical Sergeant Keene to Private Wilt, 'Goodwin, Robert C., 39130554, Tec 5' the twelfth name. For a week those two dozen men were the 775th at Bhamo, laying line and setting up the fuel point in a town the Japanese had left days before. On 29 December 1944 'company headquarters moved from Myitkyina to Bhamo this date. Movement was made by truck. Weather fair and clear. Morale excellent,' and the twenty-four were 'relieved from TDY at Bhamo and joined company,' Robert's name again on the inclosure. There the digitized record stops: the morning reports for 1945 have not yet been put online. The discharge carries the story on, in its own shorthand: the campaigns of Central Burma and China Defensive as the pipeline was pushed

776 Engr PD Co 29 December 1944

Name	Serial No.	Grade
Keene, William D.	34400078	T/sgt
Read, Walter J.	33040385	S/sgt
Smith, Clyde E.	31289849	S/sgt
Good, Ralph L.	33210610	Sgt
Brown, Gerald H.	38159821	Tec 4
Woods, Ira H., Jr.	19078110	Tec 4
Barber, George J.	23473342	Tec 4
Cookhill, Robert M.	33741985	Tec 4
McClure, Nathan J.	38796061	Tec 4
Toughman, John H.	33225859	Tec 4
Clayton, Russell L.	34402118	Tec 5
Cor, Ivan D.	36496184	Tec 5
Goodwin, Robert C.	39130554	Tec 5
Erdak, Joseph S.	33382284	Tec 5
Hutton, George E.	35140495	Tec 5
McDonald, Richard D.	38743046	Tec 5
Bummers, Frank H.	39132877	Tec 5
Miller, Chasney W.	34803216	Pfc
Hall, Leon L.	34606938	Pfc
Barvallet, Weldon A.	36872877	Pvt
Fox, David W.	32444369	Pvt
Ellis, Harold B.	39317196	Pvt
Pickington, James H.	31307072	Pvt
Wilt, William H.	35697898	Pvt

Encl #1 to #4
For 29 Dec 44.

Hugh C. Adams
HUGH C. ADAMS, CAPT, CG.

Inclosure No. 1 to the morning report of 29 December 1944: the twenty-four men released from temporary duty at Bhamo the day the company headquarters moved there. 'Goodwin, Robert C., 39130554, Tec 5' is the twelfth name. National Archives, Record Group 64, Morning Reports, December 1944, roll 731.

east from Bhamo over the Shweli and the Salween to reach China on 9 April 1945; an Adjusted Service Rating score of 64 points on 2 September 1945, the day Japan signed the surrender; and his departure from the theater on 11 December 1945.

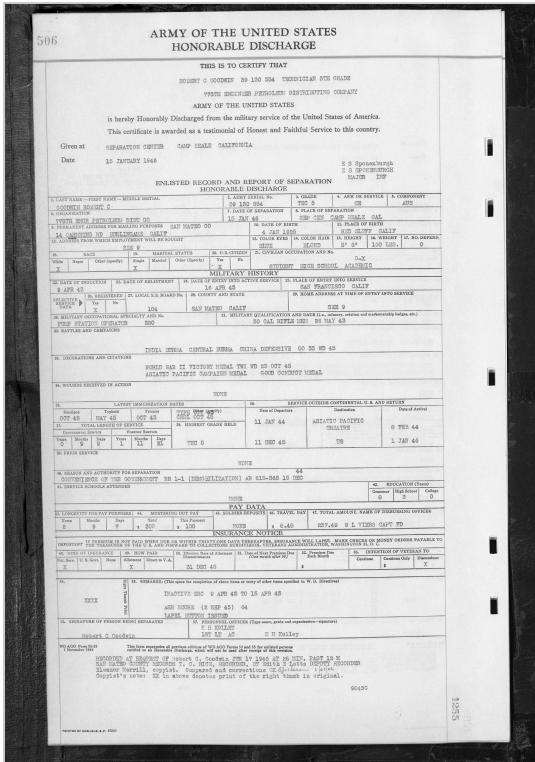
He left the theater on 11 December 1945 and reached the United States on New Year's Day 1946. Two weeks later, on 15 January 1946, he was honorably discharged at the Separation Center at Camp Beale, north of Sacramento, a Technician Fifth Grade, a corporal's rank for a specialist's job. The Enlisted Record and Report of Separation that he took home, and had copied into the San Mateo County records on 17 June 1946, sets down the whole of it: two years, nine months and seven days of service, of which one year, eleven months and twenty-one days were overseas; the Asiatic-Pacific Campaign Medal, the Good Conduct Medal and the World War II Victory Medal; wounds received in action, none; five feet five inches, 150 pounds, blue eyes, blond hair; \$300 in mustering-out pay, \$100 of it in hand, and \$8.48 for the trip home to 14 Channing Road. He signed it Robert C Goodwin, and the copyist noted that the original carried the print of his right thumb.

BURLINGAME, 1946 TO 1950

Brake repairman

He went back to Channing Road and back to the tire shop. The Burlingame city directories list him in 1946, 1947 and 1948, and the census taker who called at the Rocha house on 14 Channing Road in April 1950 wrote him down as 25, single, a brake repairman at a tire sales and repair station, working a 35-hour week, in a household of four: Joseph P. Rocha, 45, head, a business proprietor and partner; Lenora, 45; Robert, stepson; and Patricia, 21, stepdaughter, a bookkeeper.

The census taker was behind the news. Robert had met Peggy Lou Fergon, born Peggy Lou Miller at Pierre, South Dakota, in 1926, a sergeant's daughter who had come to the Peninsula as the wife of a San Mateo airman, Rodney Fergon, and had two small sons by him. Her husband had published the customary notice in the San Mateo Times in January 1949 that he would no longer be responsible for her debts. On 18 February 1950 Peggy gave birth to a daughter in Santa Cruz County, Susan Lenora, named for Robert's mother. Ten days later, on 28 February 1950, Robert C. Goodwin and Peggy Fergon were married at Carson City, Nevada, where a couple could



The Honorable Discharge and Enlisted Record, Camp Beale, 15 January 1946, recorded in San Mateo County on 17 June 1946 at Robert's own request.

marry the day they arrived. When the census taker came to Channing Road five weeks after that, whoever answered the door said Robert was single.

REDWOOD CITY, 1951 TO 1954

Peggy, Susan and Betty

The Goodwins set up house in Redwood City. Their second daughter, Elizabeth Anne, was born there on 29 May 1951; she has been Betty all her life, and she is Bobby's mother. The 1953 Redwood City directory has the family at 221 Alameda de las Pulgas, Robert a mechanic, Peggy beside him in the parentheses that directories reserve for a wife. It is the last record that shows them together. The marriage ended in the middle 1950s, on a date and in a courtroom the indexes do not reach; by 1956 Robert was living at Channing Road again, and in December 1959 Peggy married Marvin Sumner in Las Vegas and moved to Garden Farms in San Luis Obispo County, where she died in 1979. Susan and Betty grew up as Goodwins on the Peninsula, in their father's and grandmother's houses.

Peggy's obituary in 1979 named them first among her children, 'Susan Inch of Boulder Creek and Betty Goodwin of San Mateo,' and when Marvin Sumner died in 2005 his obituary still listed 'Susan Inch of Boulder Creek and Betty Smith of San Mateo' among his stepchildren. Susan lived at Boulder Creek in the Santa Cruz Mountains and died a few years ago.

SAN MATEO, 1956 TO 2014

The Norfolk Street years

The San Mateo city directories carry Robert through the next quarter century almost year by year. In 1956 he is at Channing Road in Burlingame, a 'brake representative,' a salesman's title in the trade he had learned at the tire shop. By 1962 he had his own address, 753 South Norfolk Street in San Mateo, and by 1977 the directory gives it as 1753 South Norfolk Street, telephone 341-5485; the public records index still has him at 1753 South Norfolk in 1993, so that house on the east side of San Mateo, near the bay, was his home for

at least thirty years and probably to the end. In 1965, 1966 and 1968 the directories put a 'Betty' with him: his daughter Elizabeth, then a teenager, living at home. In 1969 he is a mechanic again, working for Dick Bullis, the San Mateo car dealer.

On 26 October 1969, at 44, he married Laverne P. Codoni, 40, in San Mateo; the directories of 1974 and 1976 list them together, and the state index records their divorce in San Mateo County in February 1981. His stepfather Joseph Rocha died at Mills Hospital in February 1973, at 68, and the San Mateo Times obituary named Robert among his sons. His mother Nora lived on in Burlingame to 93, dying in January 1998; she and Joseph lie together under a shared bronze marker at Skylawn Memorial Park on the ridge above San Mateo, and his sister Patricia, who never married and died in 2015, is in the same section. His father Charles died in Martinez in 1985; his sister Dolores Farrell in 2009; his brother Harold in 2002.

Robert Charles Goodwin died on 13 March 2014, at 89, the last of Nora's children but one. A cousin's family tree places the death at Burlingame, where his life on the Peninsula had begun seventy years before. He was buried as a veteran at Skylawn Memorial Park, in the veterans' section on the ridge above San Mateo, the same cemetery where his mother, his stepfather Joseph Rocha and his sister Patricia lie, so the household of Channing Road rests together on the hill above the town where he spent the rest of his life. His grandson Robert Anthony Goodwin, Bobby, born in 1983, carries his first name, and Bobby's daughter Elizabeth Lenora carries his mother's and his daughter's.

UNFINISHED

What is still to be found

Robert's grave is known to the family, in the veterans' section at Skylawn Memorial Park, but it has left no trace online: the Department of Veterans Affairs' Nationwide Gravesite Locator, which lists private-cemetery burials only when the government supplied the marker, has no entry for him, and none of the seven Goodwins with Find a Grave memorials at Skylawn is Robert, so a photograph of his marker and a memorial page are for the family to add. No obituary has been found either; the San Mateo Daily Journal, the paper most likely to have carried a notice in March 2014, is not in the online archives. No photograph of him as an adult has surfaced in the public trees; the family may hold the only ones.

The 775th's morning reports for 1943 and 1944, digitized by the National Archives, are the backbone of the war chapters above; the reports for 1945 are not yet online, and when they are they will say whether Robert went on from Bhamo toward China and where he stood on V-J Day. The company's own fifty-two-leaf 'Narrative History of 775,' written in 1945, is held by the U.S. Army Heritage and Education Center at Carlisle, Pennsylvania, and his Official Military Personnel File, if it survived the 1973 fire, can be requested from the National Personnel Records Center in St. Louis. Family memory credits him with 'three bronze stars' and with Purple Hearts. The first is exactly right in the Army's own terms, since each of his three campaigns is a bronze service star worn on the ribbon of the Asiatic-Pacific Campaign Medal; the second the record does not support, for the discharge says 'wounds received in action: none,' and the only hospital entry in two years of morning reports is four days of sickness at Myitkyina in November 1944. The San Mateo County Superior Court holds the file of his divorce from Peggy, which would date the end of that marriage. And anyone in the family who remembers Bob Goodwin of Norfolk Street, mechanic, veteran of the Ledo Road, could add more to this page than any archive.

1921 TO 2014

Timeline

1921	Charles Herbert Goodwin, 24, marries Nora Foley, 17, at Red Bluff, 21 November	1933	Nora marries Joseph Perry Rocha at Gold Beach, Oregon, 5 May; Robert is eight
1923	Sister Dolores born, Tehama County, 28 August	1935	The family moves to San Francisco
1925	Robert Charles Goodwin born at Red Bluff, 4 January	1940	Census: 517 Shotwell Street, San Francisco; Robert, 15, in the eighth grade
1926	Brother Harold Philip born at Cottage Grove, Oregon, 8 December	1942	Usher at his sister Dolores's wedding, St. Catherine's, Burlingame, 6 June
1928	Sister Patricia Mae born in Humboldt County, 31 May	1943	Registers for the draft on his eighteenth birthday, 4 January; inducted at San Francisco, 9 April; active duty 16 April; rifle marksman 26 May
1930	Census: 539 J Street, Eureka; mother head of the household, father absent		

1943	Quartermaster Replacement Training Center, Fort Francis E. Warren, Wyoming; 2d Quartermaster Training Regiment, carded as an automotive mechanic; transferred 2 August to Camp Ellis, Illinois; Company B, 619th Quartermaster Bakery Battalion, 12 August	1944	Fifth 10,000-barrel tank finished at the Myitkyina tank farm and two lines laid across the Irrawaddy, 20 December; one of twenty-four men sent ahead to Bhamo, 21 December; company headquarters moves to Bhamo, 29 December
1943	Transferred 2 September to the new 775th Engineer Petroleum Distribution Company, Camp Claiborne, Louisiana; twelve-day furlough home, 14 to 26 November; on the December payroll with a \$10,000 life insurance policy	1945	Campaigns: India-Burma, Central Burma, China Defensive; the pipeline reaches China, 9 April; 64 points on V-J Day; leaves the theater 11 December
1944	Boards the Empress of Scotland at Hampton Roads, Virginia, 9 January; sails 11 January; Cape Town, 28 January; Bombay, 8 February; by special train and river steamer across India to Baragolai, beside Ledo, Assam, 18 February	1946	Lands in the United States 1 January; discharged at Camp Beale as Technician Fifth Grade, 15 January; discharge recorded in San Mateo County, 17 June
1944	Company camps at mile post 123 of the Ledo Road, in Burma, 4 April; detachments at mile post 155 and Warazup in August; his company photographed unloading pipe at Myitkyina, 10 August	1946-48	Burlingame city directories, 14 Channing Road
1944	Appointed Technician Fifth Grade at Ledo, 1 September; company station moves to Myitkyina (APO 218), 7 September; sick in the 48th Evacuation Hospital, Myitkyina, 21 to 25 November	1950	Daughter Susan Lenora born in Santa Cruz County, 18 February; marries Peggy Fergon at Carson City, 28 February; census lists him single at Channing Road, brake repairman
		1951	Daughter Elizabeth Anne, 'Betty', born at Redwood City, 29 May
		1953	Redwood City directory: 221 Alameda de las Pulgas, mechanic, with Peggy
		1956	San Mateo directory: back at Channing Road, Burlingame, brake representative
		1959	Peggy marries Marvin Sumner in Las Vegas, 8 December
		1962	753 South Norfolk Street, San Mateo, representative

[illegible]

8 February 1944: 'Arrived Bombay India. Company commended on its performance of duty aboard ship. Morale excellent.'

[illegible]

9 February 1944: 'Company debarked at 0830 hours. Entrained on A Special Train No. 251, Block C, enroute to Sirajganj Ghat. Capt Adams appointed Train Commander.'

COMPANY
MORNING REPORT

THURSDAY 18 FEBRUARY 1946
STATION WJAP 90.9, c/o Postmaster, 875 N. 4th
ORGANIZATION WJAP NBC Co. (Cable Station)
SERIAL NUMBER 17528
DATE 18 FEB 1946
CITY CHICAGO

No changes.

RECORD OF SPOTS

Detained material India at 1900 hours.
Program billeted in Stage.
Weather clear and bright.
Movie excellent.

SPOTS PROGRAMS	FLD 1 CST	FLD 2 EST	FLD 3 ACT	FLD 4 ACT	FLD 5 ACT	FLD 6 ACT	FLD 7 ACT	FLD 8 ACT
SPOTS			1	1	1			
PROGRAMS								
TOTAL			1	1	1			
SPOTS								
PROGRAMS								
TOTAL								
SPOTS								
PROGRAMS								
TOTAL								

REMARKS: 225 hours 225 spots 225 spots 225 spots 225 spots 225 spots 225 spots 225 spots 225 spots

PAGE 1 OF 1 PAGES

WJAP 90.9, c/o Postmaster, 875 N. 4th
CHICAGO, ILL.

18 February 1944: 'Detrained
Baragolai India at 1900 hours.
Troops billeted in Staging Area.'
The company had reached Ledo.

COMPANY		THIRD CLASS		4 April		4	
MORNING REPORT							
STATION		New Rep 3		4000, 6/0 76		NY, NY	
ORGANIZATION		77458 New 50.		US		08	
SERIAL NUMBER	NAME			GRADE		DATE	
3745727	Norman			Sgt		576	
Sgt at 21th General Hospital New							
3642836	Lt Col 63.			Sgt		775	
Sgt ditto at 1st Med in New							
Sgt 3, AIO 552							
REMARKS OF REPORTER							
Company completed movement to new							
campsite at 103 3. 75. 10000 are							
flat and dry; weather sunny and							
very, people excellent.							
DIFFER		DEPART	NO	NO	NO	NO	NO
PREP	PREP	PREP	PREP	PREP	PREP	PREP	PREP
1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8
TOTAL		1		3		3	
ATTENDING OFFICER		OFFICER		OFFICER		OFFICER	
PREP		PREP		PREP		PREP	
1		2		3		4	
TOTAL		1		3		3	
PREP		PREP		PREP		PREP	
1		2		3		4	
TOTAL		1		3		3	
PREP		PREP		PREP		PREP	
1		2		3		4	
TOTAL		1		3		3	
PREP		PREP		PREP		PREP	
1		2		3		4	
TOTAL		1		3		3	
PREP		PREP		PREP		PREP	
1		2		3		4	
TOTAL		1		3		3	
PREP		PREP		PREP		PREP	
1		2		3		4	
TOTAL		1		3		3	
PREP		PREP		PREP		PREP	
1		2		3		4	
TOTAL		1		3		3	
PREP		PREP		PREP		PREP	
1		2		3		4	
TOTAL		1		3		3	
PREP		PREP		PREP		PREP	
1		2		3		4	
TOTAL		1		3		3	
PREP		PREP		PREP		PREP	
1		2		3		4	
TOTAL		1		3		3	
PREP		PREP		PREP		PREP	
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TOTAL		1		3		3	
PREP		PREP		PREP		PREP	
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TOTAL		1		3		3	
PREP		PREP		PREP		PREP	
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TOTAL		1		3		3	
PREP		PREP		PREP		PREP	
1		2		3		4	
TOTAL		1		3		3	
PREP		PREP		PREP		PREP	
1		2		3		4	
TOTAL		1		3		3	
PREP		PREP		PREP		PREP	
1		2		3		4	
TOTAL		1		3		3	
PREP		PREP		PREP		PREP	
1		2		3		4	
TOTAL		1		3		3	
PREP		PREP		PREP		PREP	
1		2		3		4	
TOTAL		1		3		3	
PREP		PREP		PREP		PREP	
1		2		3		4	
TOTAL		1		3		3	
PREP		PREP		PREP		PREP	
1		2		3		4	
TOTAL		1		3		3	
PREP		PREP		PREP		PREP	
1		2		3		4	
TOTAL		1		3		3	

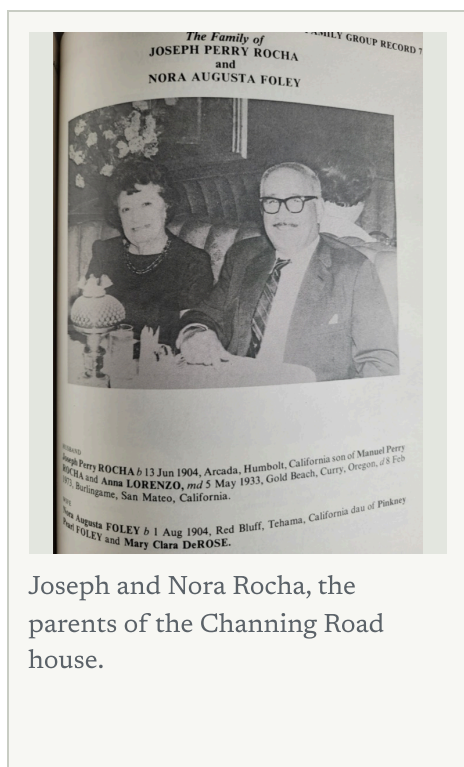
4 April 1944: 'Company completed movement to new campsite at 123 M.P.,' mile post 123 of the Ledo Road, in the Hukawng Valley of Burma.

[illegible]

13 August 1944, Base Section 3: a detachment of thirteen men at mile post 155 comes back to the company mess. In that week 116 of the company's 186 present men were messing separately at points along the line.

[illegible]

1 September 1944, APO 689
(Ledo): five men appointed
Technician Fifth Grade by
company order, 'Goodwin, Pvt'
among them.



Joseph and Nora Rocha, the parents of the Channing Road house.



Patricia Mae Goodwin (1928–2015), Robert's sister, at Skylawn Memorial Park, the cemetery where Robert also lies, in the veterans' section.

RECORDS

Sources

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2. 1930 United States census, Eureka, Humboldt County, 539 J Street (Ancestry)
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5. World War II draft registration card, 4 January 1943 (family copy; FamilySearch)
6. U.S., World War II Army Enlistment Records, 1938–1946: Robert C. Goodwin, serial 39130554, 9 April 1943 (Ancestry)
7. California, Military Discharges, 1856–1965: Enlisted Record and Report of Separation, WD AGO Form 53-55, recorded San Mateo County 17 June 1946 (FamilySearch film 005084401, image 507)
8. National Archives, Record Group 342, U.S. Air Force photograph 123481AC: members of the 775th Engineer Petroleum Distribution Company at Myitkyina, 10 August 1944 (NAID 204968074)
9. National Archives, Record Group 64, World War II Morning Reports (digitized; searchable by serial number in the catalog). Robert C. Goodwin, 39130554, appears in: August 1943, roll 239 (1 of 4), image 793, and roll 238 (3 of 4), images 108 and 291 (Fort Warren orders; Camp Ellis, 619th QM Bakery Bn); September 1943, roll 164 (1 of 4) image 573 and (3 of 4) image 262, and roll 75 (1 of 3) image 48 and (2 of 3) image 88 (transfer to the 775th); November 1943, roll 91 (3 of 4), images 871 and 889 (furlough); September 1944,

roll 704, image 794 (Tec 5); November 1944, roll 525, images 1466 and 1470 (48th Evacuation Hospital); December 1944, roll 731, images 2422 and 2431 (Bhamo)

10. National Archives, Record Group 64, Morning Reports of the 775th Engineer Petroleum Distribution Company: January 1944, roll 722 (2 of 3), images 1043 to 1083 (Camp Patrick Henry, Empress of Scotland, Cape Town); February 1944, roll 523 (3 of 4), images 2042 to 2065 (Bombay, the train across India, Baragolai); April 1944, roll 700 (1 of 5), image 850 (mile post 123); August 1944, roll 544, images 1644 to 1678 (Base Section 3, detachments); September 1944, roll 704, images 795 to 825 (APO 218 from 7 September); December 1944, roll 731, images 2419 to 2431 (tank farm, Irrawaddy, Bhamo)
11. National Archives, Record Group 64, Army and Army Air Force Rosters 1940-1943, roll 1024 (2 of 2): payroll of the 775th Engineer Petroleum Distribution Company, Camp Claiborne, December 1943
12. 'Fuel for Freedom: The Story of the ABC Pipeline,' by Sgt. Ray O. Howard, prepared by Cpl. Sherwin Lando, Office of Public Relations, U.S. Forces in the India-Burma Theater, Advance Section, APO 689, 1945 (transcribed at cbi-theater.com); and 'Along the Ledo Road,' Signal Corps photograph captions of the Myitkyina tank farm built by the 775th
13. War Department Technical Manual TM 12-427, Military Occupational Classification of Enlisted Personnel, 1944: specification serial numbers 220 (Pump Operator), 014 (Automotive Mechanic), 521 (Basic)
14. James T. Controvich, United States Army Unit and Organizational Histories: A Bibliography: '775th Engineer Petroleum Distribution Co. Narrative History of 775. N.p.: 1945. 52 leaves,' held at the U.S. Army Heritage and Education Center, Carlisle Barracks
15. 1950 United States census, Burlingame, household of Joseph P. Rocha (FamilySearch and Ancestry)
16. Carson City, Nevada, Marriage Index, 1855–1985: Robert C. Goodwin and Peggy Fergon, 28 February 1950 (Ancestry)
17. California Birth Index: Susan Lenora Goodwin, 18 February 1950, Santa Cruz County; Elizabeth Anne Goodwin, 29 May 1951, San Mateo County; mother's maiden name Miller
18. U.S. City Directories, 1822–1995: Burlingame 1946–1948; Redwood City 1953; San Mateo 1955–1977 (Ancestry)
19. San Mateo Times, 13 January 1949, p. 18 (Rodney Fergon's notice); 9 February 1973, p. 31 (obituary of Joseph P. Rocha) (Newspapers.com)
20. California Marriage Index, 1960–1985: Robert C. Goodwin and Laverne P. Codoni, San Mateo, 26 October 1969; California Divorce Index, 1966–1984: February 1981 (Ancestry)
21. U.S. Public Records Index, 1950–1993: 1753 S. Norfolk Street, San Mateo (Ancestry)
22. San Luis Obispo Telegram-Tribune, 29 January 1979 (obituary of Peggy Lou Sumner); The Tribune, 23 February 2005 (obituary of Marvon Eugene Sumner) (Newspapers.com)
23. Fold3 memorial, Robert C. Goodwin, U.S. Army, died 13 March 2014 (Ancestry)
24. Burial at Skylawn Memorial Park, San Mateo, veterans' section: family knowledge (Grace Goodwin, September 2026). Checked 4 September 2026: no entry in the VA Nationwide Gravesite Locator; none of the seven Goodwin memorials at Skylawn on Find a Grave (cemetery 8376) is Robert
25. FamilySearch Family Tree, Robert Charles Goodwin GHLM-CTK

Part of Goodwin & Oviatt Lines, the family page made for Bobby Goodwin's birthday, 4 September 2026.
Photographs of Robert's family are reproduced from copies posted by relatives and remain theirs; the Myitkyina photograph and the Missing Air Crew Report are United States government records in the public domain.

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